Field Study Report

Final International University website

Site: https://www.final.edu.tr/
Organisation: Final International University
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Audit date: 10 November 2026, (Istanbul time)
Browser: chrome, Incognito window

Part A: Under the hood

A1 HTTPS and redirects. I typed http://www.final.edu.tr and the address bar . The certificate is valid: it is issued to final.edu.tr by Google Trust Services (WE1), from 27 October 2026 to 25 January 2027. DevTools Security reports TLS 1.3 with all resources served securely. HTTPS encrypts the connection, so nobody on the same network can read or change pages in transit. The short validity period is normal for automatically renewed certificates. [A1]

A2 URL structure. I scored five URLs against the five rules.

URL	HTTPS	Readable	Lowercase	Hyphens	Few params
https://aday.final.edu.tr/	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
https://www.final.edu.tr/m-9-hakkimizda/a-21-ufu-hakkinda	Pass	Fail	Pass	Pass	Pass
https://www.final.edu.tr/online-islemler	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
http://mail.final.edu.tr/	Fail	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass
https://destek.final.edu.tr/	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass	Pass

Most addresses follow good practice and the services have short, clear subdomains. The "about" page contains internal codes (m-9-, a-21-) that mean nothing to a visitor; a cleaner address would be /hakkimizda/ufu-hakkinda. Readable addresses are easier to trust, remember and share. [A2]

A3 One request, closely. On , the first (document) request used method GET, returned status and had Content-Type . The page made requests and transferred . . A GET request only asks the server for a page without changing anything. Each extra request adds waiting time, and , which matters most for visitors on mobile data. [A3]

A4 A page that does not exist. I visited /404 and /no-such-page-123. The status code was . For /404 the visitor sees a completely blank white page, with no message, logo, menu or link back; for /no-such-page-123 the visitor sees . A good error page explains that the page was not found and offers the menu, a search box and a link home. [A4]

A5 Caching. The main document sends Cache-Control: , which means . The file sends Cache-Control: , which means . Caching lets repeat visitors skip downloading unchanged files, so pages open faster and the server does less work. Long caching suits images and scripts that rarely change, while the page itself should be checked more often so news stays fresh. [A5]

A6 Where the page is built. I searched the raw source (Ctrl+U) for the visible heading "" and . I classify the page as because Server-rendered pages show content sooner and work better for search engines and weak devices, while browser-rendered pages need JavaScript to run before anything appears. [A6]

A7 SEO basics.

Item	Found or missing, and value
rel=sponsored / ugc	Not applicable (no adverts or user comments)

The title and meta description are what searchers see in results, so weak ones reduce clicks. The canonical link avoids duplicate-page confusion, the lang attribute helps screen readers pronounce text and helps translation, and one h1 per page makes its topic clear. [A7]

Part B: The experience

B1 Loading state. On Slow 3G the visitor saw after about 1 second, after 3 seconds and after 6 seconds. Waiting without any sign of progress makes people think a site is broken, while placeholders or a spinner show that it is working. This matters because many applicants browse on mobile data. [B1]

B2 Empty state. Searching for "zzzqqq" returned: "", . A good empty state says nothing was found, suggests checking spelling or other words, and links to popular pages. [B2]

B3 Error state. With the network set to Offline I tried to . The result was . A site cannot load pages while offline, but a clear message with a retry button keeps visitors informed instead of leaving them guessing. I set the network back online afterwards. [B3]

B4 Form validation. I tested the form by submitting it with empty. Errors appeared , worded "", and what I had typed was . Good validation names the field, says how to fix it, appears next to the problem and keeps the visitor's input. No real personal data was entered. [B4]

B5 Labels.

A label tied to its field lets screen readers announce what to type and gives phone users a larger target to tap. A placeholder alone disappears while typing and is read inconsistently by assistive technology. [B5]

B6 Keyboard only. Task: . Using only Tab, Shift+Tab and Enter, I . The focus outline was , the order was , , and . Dropdown menus by keyboard. People who cannot use a mouse depend on a visible, logical focus path. [B6]

B7 Automated audit. The Lighthouse Accessibility score was for the home page and for . The top issues were: (1) ; (2) ; (3) . An automated audit catches only part of the problems, but it is a quick measure of the basics. [B7]

B8 Link and button text.

Descriptive link text lets screen-reader users understand links listed out of context, and helps everyone scan the page. [B8]

Part C: Recommendations

What works well

1. **The site is secure.** It uses a valid certificate and TLS 1.3, with every resource served securely. [A1]
2. Most addresses are clean: lowercase, no query strings, with clear subdomains for services such as applications and support. [A2]

Three problems, ranked

I ranked the blank error page first because it leaves visitors with no way forward, then the problems that affect the most people.

1. **A missing page shows a blank white screen.**
   Evidence: [A4]. Affects: anyone following an old or mistyped link, including applicants and parents. Fix: show a friendly "page not found" screen with the menu, a search box and a link to the home page. Effort: low. Impact: medium.

2. **Some page addresses contain internal codes.**
   Evidence: [A2]. Affects: visitors who share or remember links, and search engines. Fix: replace addresses such as `/m-9-hakkimizda/a-21-ufu-hakkinda` with readable ones like `/hakkimizda/ufu-hakkinda`, keeping redirects from the old ones. Effort: medium. Impact: low.

3.
   Evidence: . Affects: . Fix: . Effort: . Impact: .

Appendix: Evidence log

ID	File	What it shows	Time and date
A1	evidence/A1-padlock.png, A1-security.png	Certificate and TLS 1.3	, 10 Nov 2026
A2	evidence/A2-urls.png	Five URLs	, 10 Nov 2026
A3	evidence/A3-request.png	Document request and totals	, 10 Nov 2026
A4	evidence/A4-missing-page.png	Missing page and status	, 10 Nov 2026
A5	evidence/A5-cache.png	Cache-Control headers	, 10 Nov 2026
A6	evidence/A6-source.png, A6-elements.png	Source versus Elements	, 10 Nov 2026
A7	evidence/A7-seo.png	Title, description, lang	, 10 Nov 2026
B1	evidence/B1-loading-1.png, -2, -3	Slow 3G loading	, 10 Nov 2026
B2	evidence/B2-empty.png	Search for zzzqqq	, 10 Nov 2026
B3	evidence/B3-offline.png	Offline state	, 10 Nov 2026
B4	evidence/B4-form-errors.png	Form errors	, 10 Nov 2026
B5	evidence/B5-labels.png	Field labels	, 10 Nov 2026
B6	evidence/B6-keyboard.png	Keyboard focus	, 10 Nov 2026
B7	evidence/B7-lighthouse-home.png, -inner.png	Lighthouse reports	, 10 Nov 2026
B8	evidence/B8-links.png	Vague link text	, 10 Nov 2026